

LITERATURE SEARCH LOG

Background research goes faster when you track where you have already looked. Fill in one row per search.

SEARCH LOG

Record every search, including the ones that found nothing. Knowing what you already tried saves you repeating it.

DATE	WHERE I SEARCHED	SEARCH WORDS I USED	USEFUL?	WHAT I FOUND

PLACES WORTH SEARCHING

- Your school or public library databases, which your librarian can get you into
- Google Scholar for peer-reviewed articles
- Government sites: NASA, NOAA, USDA, CDC, and the National Institutes of Health
- University extension sites, especially for agriculture and environmental topics
- Science magazines written for students, such as Science News Explores

WHEN A SEARCH FINDS NOTHING

Change your words rather than your topic. Try the scientific term instead of the everyday one, drop your search to two words, or search the thing you are measuring rather than the thing you are testing.